Himaayah Schools
MADRASAH

MADRASAH EDITION

ثَلَاثَةُ الْأُصُولِ

The Three Fundamental Principles

The Three Principles

Know your Lord, your religion and your Prophet ﷺ: a study edition with deep explanations, summaries, short essays and a practical test.

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَٰنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Welcome

Assalaamualaykum wa rahmatullah. *Thalāthat al-Uṣūl*, “The Three Principles”, is one of the first texts a student of knowledge learns. It teaches the three questions every person will be asked: **Who is your Lord? What is your religion? Who is your Prophet?** This is the Himaayah Madrasah edition, made for students aged 16 to 27.

The text was written by Imām Muḥammad ibn ʿAbd al-Wahhāb (d. 1206 AH). We give the Arabic of its key passages with a clear English translation of our own, then **explain each chapter in depth**, list the key terms, **summarise**, set a **short essay** and a **practical task**, and finish with a quiz. At the end there is a **final practical test** with an answer guide.

How to use this book

Take **one chapter at a time**. Read the Arabic aloud, then the translation, then the explanation.

Write the **essay** by hand before you read the guide points. Then compare.

Do the **practical task** within the week. Knowledge is for action (Chapter 1).

Take the quiz, check the answers at the back, and revisit any chapter where you lost marks.

A note on the Arabic and the translation

The English is our own wording, not a copy of any published translation. The Arabic passages are given for study; a teacher should hear your recitation and correct it. This edition has been prepared for review by the Madrasah teachers.

About the book and its author

Shaykh Muḥammad ibn ʿAbd al-Wahhāb (1115–1206 AH, 1703–1792 CE) was a scholar from Najd who called people back to the tawḥīd taught by the Qur'an and the Sunnah. He wrote short, clear texts so that ordinary people could learn the basics of the religion with proofs. *The Three Principles* is the most famous of them and is memorised in many circles of knowledge worldwide.

The book is built around three questions and one idea. The questions are the ones asked in the grave. The idea is that every answer must come with **proof** (dalīl), meaning a verse from the Qur'an or a ḥadīth. The structure below shows the whole course at a glance.

Part	Chapters	Question it answers
Foundations	1–2	Why must I learn, and what do I owe Allah?
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Second principle	5–6	What is your religion?
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Chapter 1 Four matters every Muslim must learn

Knowledge, action, calling, patience

The text

اعْلَمْ رَحِمَكَ اللَّهُ أَنَّهُ يَجِبُ عَلَيْنَا تَعَلُّمُ أَرْبَعِ مَسَائِلَ: الأُولَى: الْعِلْمُ، وَهُوَ مَعْرِفَةُ اللَّهِ، وَمَعْرِفَةُ نَبِيِّهِ، وَمَعْرِفَةُ دِينِ الإِسْلامِ بِالأَدِلَّةِ. الثَّانِيَةُ: الْعَمَلُ بِهِ. الثَّالِثَةُ: الدَّعْوَةُ إِلَيْهِ. الرَّابِعَةُ: الصَّبْرُ عَلَى الأَذَى فِيهِ.

Know, may Allah have mercy on you, that we must learn four matters. First: knowledge, which is knowing Allah, knowing His Prophet and knowing the religion of Islam with its proofs. Second: acting on it. Third: calling others to it. Fourth: being patient with the harm that comes in doing so.

Imām Muḥammad ibn ʿAbd al-Wahhāb, opening of the text

وَالْعَصْرِ، إِنَّ الإِنْسَانَ لَفِي خُسْرٍ، إِلاَّ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا وَعَمِلُوا الصَّالِحَاتِ وَتَوَاصَوْا بِالْحَقِّ وَتَوَاصَوْا بِالصَّبْرِ.

By time. Indeed mankind is in loss, except those who believe, do righteous deeds, advise each other to truth and advise each other to patience.

Sūrat al-ʿAṣr 103:1–3

قَالَ الشَّافِعِيُّ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: لَوْ مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ حُجَّةً عَلَى خَلْقِهِ إِلاَّ هَذِهِ السُّورَةَ لَكَفَتْهُمْ.

Imām ash-Shāfiʿī said: If Allah had sent down no proof to His creation except this sūrah, it would have been enough for them.

Reported from ash-Shāfiʿī

Deep explanation

The author opens with a ladder of four rungs. Each rung depends on the one before it, and a person who skips a rung falls. **Knowledge** comes first because worship without knowledge is guessing. The

knowledge meant here is not trivia; it is knowing who your Lord is, who your Prophet is and what your religion asks of you, each with its proof from the Qur'an and Sunnah.

Action is the fruit of knowledge. Knowing that prayer is obligatory and not praying is the situation the Qur'an warns about when it speaks of people who know and do not act. Imām al-Bukhārī made this a chapter title: "Knowledge before speech and action", and brought the verse "So know that there is no god but Allah" (Muḥammad 47:19). Allah commanded knowing first, then seeking forgiveness, which is an action.

Calling to Allah (daʿwah) follows because what we have been given is a trust. You do not need a pulpit for this. A student who explains a ruling to a younger sibling, or a young adult who politely corrects a mistake at work, is calling to Allah. The method is wisdom and good speech, not harshness.

Patience closes the ladder because everyone who acts and calls will be tested: mockery, loneliness, loss of an opportunity. Sūrat al-ʿAṣr shows all four in three verses: faith and knowledge ("believe"), action ("righteous deeds"), calling ("advise each other to truth") and patience ("advise each other to patience"). Everyone, the verse says, is in loss unless they hold all four. That is why ash-Shāfiʿī said this one short sūrah is enough as a warning.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
ʿIlm	Knowledge that is backed by proof and leads to action
Daʿwah	Inviting people to Allah with wisdom and good speech
Ṣabr	Patience: staying firm in obedience, away from sin, and through trials
Khusr	Loss: the state of every person except those who combine the four matters

Chapter summary

- Four matters: know, act, call, be patient.
- Knowledge comes before speech and action.
- Sūrat al-ʿAṣr contains all four; every person is in loss except those who hold them.
- Knowledge here means knowing Allah, His Prophet ﷺ and Islam with proofs.

Short essay

Question: In about 150 words, explain why the author puts knowledge before action, and give one example from your own life.

Write your answer on a separate page. Compare it with the guide points at the back of the book.

Practical task

Write the four matters on a card. Next to each, write one thing you will do this week to practise it (for example: read one page of a tafsīr; correct one mistake in my wuḍūʾ; share one ḥadīth with a friend; stay calm when someone mocks me for praying).

Quick quiz

Choose the best answer. Answers are at the back of the book.

1. **Which is the FIRST of the four matters?**
   a) Calling to Allah b) Patience c) Giving charity d) Knowledge

2. **Which sūrah did ash-Shāfiʿī say would be enough as a proof against people?**
   a) Sūrat al-Ikhlāṣ b) Sūrat al-Fātiḥah c) Sūrat al-Kawthar d) Sūrat al-ʿAṣr

3. **In Sūrat al-ʿAṣr, who is NOT in loss?**
   a) Everyone who is wealthy b) Everyone who knows a lot c) Only the scholars d) Those who believe, do righteous deeds, advise to truth and to patience

4. **Al-Bukhārī titled a chapter:**
   a) Action before knowledge b) Speech before action c) Knowledge without action d) Knowledge before speech and action

Chapter 2 Three matters and the path of Ibrāhīm

Obey the Messenger, worship Allah alone, and keep your loyalty clear

The text

اعْلَمْ رَحِمَكَ اللَّهُ أَنَّهُ يَجِبُ عَلَى كُلِّ مُسْلِمٍ وَمُسْلِمَةٍ تَعَلُّمُ هَذِهِ الثَّلاثِ مَسَائِلَ وَالْعَمَلُ بِهِنَّ: الأُولَى: أَنَّ اللَّهَ خَلَقَنَا وَرَزَقَنَا وَلَمْ يَتْرُكْنَا هَمَلاً، بَلْ أَرْسَلَ إِلَيْنَا رَسُولاً، فَمَنْ أَطَاعَهُ دَخَلَ الْجَنَّةَ، وَمَنْ عَصَاهُ دَخَلَ النَّارَ.

Know, may Allah have mercy on you, that it is obligatory upon every Muslim man and woman to learn these three matters and act on them. First: that Allah created us and provided for us and did not leave us without purpose; rather He sent us a Messenger. Whoever obeys him enters Paradise, and whoever disobeys him enters the Fire.

Opening of the second preface

الثَّانِيَةُ: أَنَّ اللَّهَ لا يَرْضَى أَنْ يُشْرَكَ مَعَهُ أَحَدٌ فِي عِبَادَتِهِ، لا مَلَكٌ مُقَرَّبٌ، وَلا نَبِيٌّ مُرْسَلٌ.

Second: that Allah is not pleased for anyone to be associated with Him in His worship, whether an angel brought near or a prophet sent.

Supported by Sūrat al-Jinn 72:18

الثَّالِثَةُ: أَنَّ مَنْ أَطَاعَ الرَّسُولَ وَوَحَّدَ اللَّهَ لا يَجُوزُ لَهُ مُوَالاةُ مَنْ حَادَّ اللَّهَ وَرَسُولَهُ، وَلَوْ كَانَ أَقْرَبَ قَرِيبٍ.

Third: whoever obeys the Messenger and singles out Allah in worship may not take as close allies those who oppose Allah and His Messenger, even if they are the nearest of relatives.

Supported by Sūrat al-Mujādilah 58:22

اعْلَمْ أَرْشَدَكَ اللَّهُ لِطَاعَتِهِ أَنَّ الْحَنِيفِيَّةَ مِلَّةَ إِبْرَاهِيمَ: أَنْ تَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ وَحْدَهُ، مُخْلِصًا لَهُ الدِّينَ.

Know, may Allah guide you to His obedience, that ḥanīfiyyah, the way of Ibrāhīm, is that you worship Allah alone, making the religion purely for Him.

Third preface

وَمَا خَلَقْتُ الْجِنَّ وَالإِنْسَ إِلاَّ لِيَعْبُدُونِ.

I did not create jinn and mankind except to worship Me.

Sūrat adh-Dhāriyāt 51:56

وَأَعْظَمُ مَا أَمَرَ اللَّهُ بِهِ التَّوْحِيدُ، وَهُوَ إِفْرَادُ اللَّهِ بِالْعِبَادَةِ. وَأَعْظَمُ مَا نَهَى عَنْهُ الشِّرْكُ، وَهُوَ دَعْوَةُ غَيْرِهِ مَعَهُ.

The greatest thing Allah commanded is tawḥīd, which is singling out Allah for worship. The greatest thing He forbade is shirk, which is calling on someone else alongside Him.

Third preface

Deep explanation

These two short prefaces answer three questions that every young person eventually asks: *Why am I here? Who do I answer to? Where do my loyalties go?*

Why am I here? The first matter says you were not made for nothing. Allah created you, feeds you, keeps you alive and sent a Messenger to guide you. Sūrat adh-Dhāriyāt gives the purpose in one line: worship. Worship here is wider than ritual; it is everything Allah loves and is pleased with, spoken or silent, outward or inward. Studying to support your family, with the right intention, becomes worship. Prayer without sincerity is empty.

Who do I answer to? The second matter is the core of tawḥīd: no partner with Allah, not even the best of His creation. Angels such as Jibrīl and prophets such as Muḥammad ﷺ would themselves be the first to refuse worship. So no saint, grave, leader or object receives a share of what belongs to Allah alone: our prayer, our dependence, our hope and our fear.

Where do my loyalties go? The third matter is about wala' and bara' (loyalty and disassociation) and it is often misunderstood. It does not permit cruelty to non-Muslim neighbours or relatives; Allah

commands kindness and justice to those who do not fight us (al-Mumtaḥanah 60:8). It means that your deepest love and allegiance belong to Allah and His Messenger, so you do not support what opposes the religion itself, even when a relative asks you to.

The author then names the path of Ibrāhīm. *Ḥanīf* means one who turns away from everything false and turns toward Allah. Tawḥīd is the greatest command and shirk the greatest prohibition, because every other command follows from the first and every other sin is smaller than the second. The rest of the book is the detail of this single idea.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Tawḥīd	Singling Allah out in lordship, worship and His names and attributes
Shirk	Giving to someone else what belongs to Allah alone
Ḥanīf	One who turns away from falsehood and worships Allah alone, like Ibrāhīm
Ikhlāṣ	Sincerity: doing the deed purely for Allah
Muwālāh	Taking someone as a close ally and supporter

Chapter summary

- Three matters: Allah sent a Messenger; no partner in worship; no loyalty to those who oppose Allah and His Messenger.
- We were created to worship Allah.
- The religion of Ibrāhīm is worship of Allah alone with sincerity.
- Tawḥīd is the greatest command; shirk the greatest prohibition.

Short essay

Question: In about 150 words, explain what it means that we were created “to worship Allah”, without limiting worship to prayer.

Write your answer on a separate page. Compare it with the guide points at the back of the book.

Practical task

Make a table with two columns: “Things I do that are clearly worship” and “Everyday things that can become worship with the right intention”. Fill at least five lines in each column.

Quick quiz

Choose the best answer. Answers are at the back of the book.

1. **Why did Allah create jinn and mankind?**
   a) To rule the earth b) To gather wealth c) To worship Him d) To compete

2. What is tawḥīd?

a) Singling out Allah for worship b) Fasting in Ramaḍān c) Reciting the Qur'an d) Giving zakāh

3. What is the greatest thing Allah forbade?

a) Lying b) Stealing c) Wasting time d) Shirk

4. Ḥanīfiyyah is the way of:

a) Ibrāhīm b) Mūsā only c) Yūsuf d) Nūḥ only

Chapter 3 The first principle: knowing your Lord

Who is your Lord, and how do you know Him?

The text

فَإِذَا قِيلَ لَكَ: مَا الأُصُولُ الثَّلاثَةُ الَّتِي يَجِبُ عَلَى الإِنْسَانِ مَعْرِفَتُهَا؟ فَقُلْ: مَعْرِفَةُ الْعَبْدِ رَبَّهُ، وَدِينَهُ، وَنَبِيَّهُ مُحَمَّدًا صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ.

If it is said to you: What are the three principles a person must know? Say: a servant's knowledge of his Lord, his religion and his Prophet Muḥammad ﷺ.

The three principles

فَإِذَا قِيلَ لَكَ: مَنْ رَبُّكَ؟ فَقُلْ: رَبِّيَ اللَّهُ الَّذِي رَبَّانِي، وَرَبَّى جَمِيعَ الْعَالَمِينَ بِنِعَمِهِ، وَهُوَ مَعْبُودِي، لَيْسَ لِي مَعْبُودٌ سِوَاهُ.

If it is said to you: Who is your Lord? Say: My Lord is Allah, who has nurtured me and all the worlds with His favours. He is my object of worship; I have no object of worship besides Him.

First principle

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ.

All praise is for Allah, Lord of the worlds.

Sūrat al-Fātiḥah 1:2

فَإِذَا قِيلَ لَكَ: بِمَ عَرَفْتَ رَبَّكَ؟ فَقُلْ: بِآيَاتِهِ وَمَخْلُوقَاتِهِ، وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ اللَّيْلُ وَالنَّهَارُ وَالشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ، وَمِنْ مَخْلُوقَاتِهِ السَّمَاوَاتُ السَّبْعُ وَالأَرَضُونَ السَّبْعُ وَمَنْ فِيهِنَّ وَمَا بَيْنَهُمَا.

If it is said to you: How did you know your Lord? Say: through His signs and His creation. Among His signs are the night and the day, the sun and the moon; among His creation are the seven heavens, the seven earths, those in them and what is between them.

First principle

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ اللَّيْلُ وَالنَّهَارُ وَالشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ لا تَسْجُدُوا لِلشَّمْسِ وَلا لِلْقَمَرِ وَاسْجُدُوا لِلَّهِ الَّذِي خَلَقَهُنَّ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ إِيَّاهُ تَعْبُدُونَ.

Among His signs are the night and the day, the sun and the moon. Do not prostrate to the sun or the moon, but prostrate to Allah who created them, if it is Him you worship.

Sūrat Fuṣṣilat 41:37

وَالرَّبُّ هُوَ الْمَعْبُودُ.

The Lord is the One who is worshipped.

First principle

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اعْبُدُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ وَالَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُونَ

O mankind, worship your Lord who created you and those before you, that you may become mindful of Him.

Sūrat al-Baqarah 2:21

قَالَ ابْنُ كَثِيرٍ رَحِمَهُ اللَّهُ تَعَالَى: الْخَالِقُ لِهَذِهِ الأَشْيَاءِ هُوَ الْمُسْتَحِقُّ لِلْعِبَادَةِ.

Ibn Kathīr said: The Creator of these things is the One who deserves worship.

Tafsīr Ibn Kathīr

Deep explanation

The first question of the grave is "Who is your Lord?". The author trains the student to answer it before it is asked. He gives two parts: the answer and the evidence.

The answer. "My Lord is Allah" means three things at once. He is the Creator (He made everything), the Owner and Controller (nothing moves without His permission) and the Nurturer (rabb comes from tarbiyah: growing something step by step, as a gardener grows a plant). Notice that the author does not stop at Creator. He ends with "He is my object of worship". The Arabs of Makkah already agreed that Allah created the heavens and earth. What they denied was that this makes Him the only One to worship. Knowing Him as Lord must lead to worshipping Him alone.

The evidence. We recognise Allah through āyāt, which means signs. There are two kinds. Signs in the universe: the cycle of night and day, the sun and moon, the heavens and earth. And the verses of the Qur'an. Think of a letter. You never need to see the writer to know someone wrote it. The orderly, precise universe is a message with a Writer. The author's verse from Fuṣṣilat adds an important warning: the sun and moon are signs *of* Allah, not partners *with* Him, so a sign must never be worshipped.

The link to worship. The author quotes al-Baqarah 2:21: "O mankind, worship your Lord who created you." The verse moves in one breath from *Lord* to *worship*. Ibn Kathīr's comment captures the logic: whoever created is the one who deserves worship. If someone else did not create you, does not provide for you and cannot save you, on what basis would you pray to him?

In modern life, "lords" take many forms: a boss who is feared as a provider, a celebrity followed without question, a trend you cannot defy. The principle of this chapter gives a simple test: who do I depend on, fear, love and obey above all? That is whom I treat as my lord.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Rabb	Lord: Creator, Owner, Controller and Nurturer
Āyah (pl. āyāt)	A sign: a verse of the Qur'an or a sign in the universe
Tarbiyah	Nurturing something step by step until it is complete
ʿĀlamīn	The worlds: everything other than Allah

Chapter summary

- The three principles: your Lord, your religion, your Prophet.
- Our Lord is Allah: Creator, Owner, Nurturer and the only One worshipped.
- We know Him through His signs: the night, day, sun, moon, heavens and earth.
- The Creator alone deserves worship. Signs are never to be worshipped.

Short essay

Question: In about 200 words, explain how a person can know Allah through His signs without seeing Him. Use at least two signs in your answer.

Write your answer on a separate page. Compare it with the guide points at the back of the book.

Practical task

Go outside at fajr, at noon or at maghrib. Write five things you notice in the sky or around you and the lesson each sign teaches about Allah (for example: the daily return of the sun, the order of the stars). Share one with a family member.

Quick quiz

Choose the best answer. Answers are at the back of the book.

1. **What does “rabb” include?**
   a) Only Creator b) Creator, Owner, Controller and Nurturer c) Only Owner d) Only Provider
2. **Through what do we know our Lord, according to the author?**
   a) Dreams b) Opinions of scholars alone c) Tradition of our parents d) His signs and His creation
3. **Which verse is used for “do not prostrate to the sun”?**
   a) Fuṣṣilat 41:37 b) al-Fātiḥah 1:2 c) al-ʿAṣr 103:1 d) al-Ikhlāṣ 112:1
4. **According to Ibn Kathīr, who deserves worship?**
   a) The most powerful king b) The Creator of these things c) The nearest angel d) The wisest scholar

Chapter 4 Worship and its types

What worship is, why it belongs to Allah alone, and what shirk does to it

The text

فَمَنْ صَرَفَ مِنْهَا شَيْئًا لِغَيْرِ اللَّهِ فَهُوَ مُشْرِكٌ كَافِرٌ.

Whoever directs any part of these acts of worship to someone other than Allah is a polytheist and has disbelieved.

Types of worship

الدُّعَاءُ مُخُّ الْعِبَادَةِ

Supplication is worship.

Ḥadīth: Abū Dāwūd and at-Tirmidhī (authentic)

Deep explanation

After saying Allah is the only One worshipped, the author must define worship. He gives a list of types: Islam, īmān and iḥsān (the three levels of the religion), and then acts of the heart and body: **supplication, fear, hope, trust (tawakkul), desire, awe, humility, reverent fear (khashyah), turning back to Allah (ināba), seeking help (istiʿānah), seeking refuge (istiʿādhah), seeking rescue (istighāthah), sacrifice and vows.** Each has its verse in the original text; the common point is that each of them is a form of humility before Allah.

A simple way to organise them is by where they happen. Some are **in the heart**: love, fear, hope, trust. Some are **on the tongue**: supplication, seeking refuge, seeking rescue. Some are **by the body and wealth**: prayer, sacrifice, vows, charity. The principle is the same in all three places: **do not give to anyone but Allah what is only for Allah.**

Why is supplication the centre? The Prophet ﷺ said that supplication *is* worship. When you call on someone, you admit three things: he hears you, he can help you and he is in control. Only Allah has those qualities in an absolute sense. A friend can lend you money, but he cannot hear your private whispers from a distance or change your heart. Calling on the dead, or on a being that is absent, for what only Allah can give is therefore the most serious deviation.

What shirk does. The author is clear and careful: whoever directs any of these acts to other than Allah is a mushrik. Two cautions are needed for the student. First, a ruling is about the act and requires knowledge and clarification of proof, so we do not hurry to label individuals; teach, explain and leave judgement to qualified scholars. Second, asking a living person for help within his ability (a loan, a lift, advice) is normal and permitted; it is not what is meant. The warning is about asking creatures for what no creature can give.

A final point: fear and hope together are the two wings of the believer. Hope alone leads to carelessness; fear alone leads to despair. Allah praises those who "call upon Us in hope and fear" (al-Anbiyā' 21:90).

Key terms

Term	Meaning
ʿIbādah	Everything Allah loves and is pleased with, in speech and action, outward and inward
Duʿā'	Supplication: asking Allah and calling on Him
Tawakkul	Trusting Allah while taking the means
Istighāthah	Asking for rescue in distress
Dhabḥ	Sacrifice offered to draw near to Allah
Nadhr	A vow to do an act of worship for Allah

Chapter summary

- Worship has many types: of the heart, tongue and body.
- Supplication, fear, hope, trust, sacrifice, vows and seeking help are all worship.
- All worship is for Allah alone.
- Directing worship to someone else is shirk.
- Asking a living person for what is within his ability is allowed; calling on creatures for what only Allah can give is shirk.

Short essay

Question: In about 200 words, explain why supplication is called the "essence" of worship and why it must be directed only to Allah.

Write your answer on a separate page. Compare it with the guide points at the back of the book.

Practical task

Sort these into heart, tongue and body: fear of Allah, saying "aʿūdhu billāh", sacrificing at ʿĪd, hope for His mercy, praying, making a vow. Then write one dua you will make daily this week, in your own language and in Arabic, and say it each morning.

Quick quiz

Choose the best answer. Answers are at the back of the book.

1. **Which of these is an act of worship?**
   a) Supplication b) Walking c) Shopping d) Reading the news

2. **What is the ruling for directing worship to other than Allah?**

   a) Permissible b) Disliked c) Shirk d) Only a minor sin

3. **Asking a friend for a lift is:**

   a) Permitted, it is within his ability b) Shirk c) Disbelief d) Forbidden

4. **Fear and hope should be:**

   a) Only fear b) Only hope c) Absent d) Together, balanced

Chapter 5 The second principle: knowing the religion of Islam

Islam, its three levels and its five pillars

The text

الأَصْلُ الثَّانِي: مَعْرِفَةُ دِينِ الإِسْلامِ بِالأَدِلَّةِ، وَهُوَ الاسْتِسْلامُ لِلَّهِ بِالتَّوْحِيدِ، وَالانْقِيَادُ لَهُ بِالطَّاعَةِ، وَالْبَرَاءَةُ مِنَ الشِّرْكِ وَأَهْلِهِ.

The second principle: knowing the religion of Islam with its proofs. It is submitting to Allah with tawḥīd, yielding to Him in obedience and disassociating from shirk and its people.

Second principle

وَهُوَ ثَلاثُ مَرَاتِبَ: الإِسْلامُ، وَالإِيمَانُ، وَالإِحْسَانُ.

It has three levels: Islam, īmān and iḥsān.

Second principle

فَأَرْكَانُ الإِسْلامِ خَمْسَةٌ: شَهَادَةُ أَنْ لا إِلَهَ إِلاَّ اللَّهُ وَأَنَّ مُحَمَّدًا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ، وَإِقَامُ الصَّلاةِ، وَإِيتَاءُ الزَّكَاةِ، وَصَوْمُ رَمَضَانَ، وَحَجُّ بَيْتِ اللَّهِ الْحَرَامِ.

The pillars of Islam are five: the testimony that there is no god but Allah and that Muḥammad is the Messenger of Allah; establishing prayer; giving zakāh; fasting Ramaḍān; and pilgrimage to the Sacred House of Allah.

Agreed upon (al-Bukhārī and Muslim)

شَهِدَ اللَّهُ أَنَّهُ لا إِلَهَ إِلاَّ هُوَ وَالْمَلائِكَةُ وَأُولُو الْعِلْمِ قَائِمًا بِالْقِسْطِ لا إِلَهَ إِلاَّ هُوَ الْعَزِيزُ الْحَكِيمُ.

Allah bears witness that there is no god but Him, and so do the angels and those of knowledge, standing firm in justice. There is no god but Him, the Almighty, the Wise.

Sūrat Āl ʿImrān 3:18

وَمَعْنَاهَا: لا مَعْبُودَ بِحَقٍّ إِلاَّ اللَّهُ.

Its meaning: there is nothing worshipped in truth except Allah.

Meaning of lā ilāha illā Allāh

Deep explanation

"Islam" is described here as three things: **submission through tawḥīd, obedience in action and freedom from shirk.** Each guards against a different error. Submission without tawḥīd would be formality; tawḥīd without obedience would be empty talk; and obedience while keeping shirk would mix truth with falsehood.

The author then shows that Islam has **three levels**, each higher than the last: Islam (the outward acts), īmān (the beliefs of the heart) and iḥsān (excellence). Think of them as three circles, with Islam as the widest and iḥsān as the innermost. A person can enter the outer circle quickly, but must grow towards the centre throughout life. The famous ḥadīth of Jibrīl, which we study in the next chapter, is the source.

The five pillars are the frame of a building. Remove one and the structure leans. The first pillar, the testimony, has two halves: *there is no god but Allah* (rejecting every false object of worship and affirming the One) and *Muḥammad is His Messenger* (obeying him, believing what he said, avoiding what he forbade and worshipping only as he taught). Notice that the meaning of the first half is not "no creator but Allah" (many people agreed on that) but "nothing deserves worship in truth but Allah." That is why the Messenger ﷺ told the polytheists to say it, and why they objected.

Scholars also list conditions derived from the evidence: knowledge of the meaning, certainty, acceptance, submission, truthfulness, sincerity and love. These matter for the student because the testimony is not a phrase to be said once; it is a way of life to be understood and lived.

The remaining four pillars: **prayer** (the daily meeting with Allah), **zakāh** (the right of the poor in wealth, taken as an act of worship), **fasting** (training the soul in self-control) and **ḥajj** (once in a lifetime for those who are able). Each is a pillar of *action* that anchors the testimony in daily life.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Islām	Submitting to Allah with tawḥīd, obeying Him and avoiding shirk
Shahādah	The testimony of faith
Zakāh	Obligatory charity on wealth that reaches the minimum (niṣāb)
Ḥajj	Pilgrimage to the Sacred House, once for those who are able
Rukn (pl. arkān)	A pillar: an essential part without which the whole is incomplete

Chapter summary

- Islam: submission to Allah with tawḥīd, obedience and freedom from shirk.
- Three levels: Islam, īmān, iḥsān.
- Five pillars: shahādah, prayer, zakāh, fasting, ḥajj.
- Lā ilāha illā Allāh means no one is worthy of worship in truth except Allah.

Short essay

Question: In about 200 words, explain the meaning of lā ilāha illā Allāh. Why is it more than saying "Allah is the Creator"?

Write your answer on a separate page. Compare it with the guide points at the back of the book.

Practical task

Draw a house with five pillars. Label each pillar and write one action beside it that you can do this week to strengthen it (for example: pray on time; pay zakāh al-fiṭr; fast three days; learn the meaning of the shahādah).

Quick quiz

Choose the best answer. Answers are at the back of the book.

1. **How many pillars of Islam are there?**
   a) Five b) Four c) Six d) Seven

2. **What does lā ilāha illā Allāh mean?**
   a) Nothing is worshipped in truth except Allah b) There is no creator but Allah c) Allah exists d) Allah is great

3. **What are the three levels of the religion?**
   a) Islam, īmān, iḥsān b) Fajr, ẓuhr, ʿaṣr c) Wuḍūʾ, ghusl, tayammum d) Ḥajj, ʿumrah, zakāh

4. **Which is NOT a pillar of Islam?**
   a) Prayer b) Zakāh c) Reciting a dua daily d) Fasting Ramaḍān

Chapter 6 Īmān and iḥsān

The six pillars of faith, and worshipping as though you see Allah

The text

الإِيمَانُ بِضْعٌ وَسَبْعُونَ شُعْبَةً، فَأَعْلاهَا قَوْلُ لا إِلَهَ إِلاَّ اللَّهُ، وَأَدْنَاهَا إِمَاطَةُ الأَذَى عَنِ الطَّرِيقِ، وَالْحَيَاءُ شُعْبَةٌ مِنَ الإِيمَانِ.

Īmān has over seventy branches. The highest is saying lā ilāha illā Allāh, the lowest is removing harm from the road, and modesty is a branch of faith.

Muslim

وَأَرْكَانُهُ سِتَّةٌ: أَنْ تُؤْمِنَ بِاللَّهِ، وَمَلائِكَتِهِ، وَكُتُبِهِ، وَرُسُلِهِ، وَالْيَوْمِ الآخِرِ، وَتُؤْمِنَ بِالْقَدَرِ خَيْرِهِ وَشَرِّهِ.

Its pillars are six: that you believe in Allah, His angels, His books, His messengers, the Last Day, and that you believe in the divine decree, its good and its bad.

Ḥadīth of Jibrīl (Muslim)

أَنْ تَعْبُدَ اللَّهَ كَأَنَّكَ تَرَاهُ، فَإِنْ لَمْ تَكُنْ تَرَاهُ فَإِنَّهُ يَرَاكَ.

Iḥsān is one pillar: that you worship Allah as though you see Him, and if you do not see Him, then indeed He sees you.

Ḥadīth of Jibrīl (Muslim)

Deep explanation

Īmān is belief in the heart, speech by the tongue and action by the limbs. It rises with obedience and falls with sin. The ḥadīth says it has more than seventy branches, from the highest (the testimony) to the lowest (removing something harmful from the road). The branches include prayer, honesty, kindness to parents, modesty and many others. So faith is not just a belief you hold; it is a whole way of living.

The six pillars of faith are the foundations. *Belief in Allah* is belief in His existence, lordship, right to worship and perfect names and attributes. *The angels* are noble creatures of light who carry

out His commands. *The books* include the Tawrāt, Injīl, Zabūr, scrolls of Ibrāhīm and the Qur'an, which is the final and preserved word. *The messengers* run from Nūḥ to Muḥammad ﷺ, the last. *The Last Day* includes death, the grave, resurrection and the reckoning. *The decree* (qadar) means that Allah knows all things, wrote them, willed them and created them, while we keep real choice and responsibility.

A student often asks: if everything is decreed, why work? The answer of the Companions was that we are commanded to act, and the decree is hidden from us. A person who falls ill goes to a doctor; he does not say "it is written." Taking the means is part of the decree itself.

Iḥsān is the highest level. It has a single pillar with two states. The first is *mushāhadah*: worship as though you see Him, with love and longing. The second is *murāqabah*: if you do not see Him, remember that He sees you. Imagine a student in an exam with the teacher standing beside him, and then imagine a student with the same teacher watching from far away through a camera. Both stay careful. The believer lives with that awareness in prayer, at work, and above all in private when no one else is present.

Iḥsān also means excellence in how we treat people: the Prophet ﷺ said that Allah has prescribed excellence in everything. It includes doing a job properly, being kind in speech and giving more than is due.

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Īmān	Belief in the heart, statement of the tongue and action of the limbs
Qadar	The divine decree: knowledge, writing, will and creation
Iḥsān	Worshipping Allah as though you see Him
Ḥayāʾ	Modesty: a branch of faith
Murāqabah	Constant awareness that Allah is watching

Chapter summary

- Īmān has over seventy branches.
- Six pillars: Allah, angels, books, messengers, the Last Day and the decree.
- Iḥsān: worship as though you see Allah; if not, He sees you.
- Faith rises with obedience and falls with sin.

Short essay

Question: In about 200 words, explain how iḥsān would change the way a student studies, prays and uses his phone.

Write your answer on a separate page. Compare it with the guide points at the back of the book.

Practical task

List the six pillars of faith on one page. Beside each, write one evidence (a verse or ḥadīth you know) and one habit it should produce. Then choose one private habit this week (for example, no phone in the toilet; lowering your gaze) and practise it for seven days with iḥsān in mind.

Quick quiz

Choose the best answer. Answers are at the back of the book.

1. **How many pillars of faith are there?**
   a) Six b) Five c) Seven d) Four

2. **The lowest branch of faith in the ḥadīth is:**
   a) Giving charity b) Removing harm from the road c) Fasting d) Smiling

3. **Iḥsān means:**
   a) Memorise much b) Pray extra only c) Worship Allah as though you see Him d) Give everything away

4. **Qadar means:**
   a) The Last Day b) The scrolls of Ibrāhīm c) The prayer direction d) The divine decree

Chapter 7 The third principle: knowing your Prophet ﷺ

His lineage, age, mission and place of hijrah

The text

الأَصْلُ الثَّالِثُ: مَعْرِفَةُ نَبِيِّكُمْ مُحَمَّدٍ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ، وَهُوَ مُحَمَّدُ بْنُ عَبْدِ اللَّهِ بْنِ عَبْدِ الْمُطَّلِبِ بْنِ هَاشِمٍ، وَهَاشِمٌ مِنْ قُرَيْشٍ، وَقُرَيْشٌ مِنَ الْعَرَبِ، وَالْعَرَبُ مِنْ ذُرِّيَّةِ إِسْمَاعِيلَ بْنِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ الْخَلِيلِ.

The third principle: knowing your Prophet Muḥammad ﷺ. He is Muḥammad ibn ʿAbdillāh ibn ʿAbd al-Muṭṭalib ibn Hāshim. Hāshim is from Quraysh, Quraysh are from the Arabs, and the Arabs are from the descendants of Ismāʿīl son of Ibrāhīm, the intimate friend of Allah.

Third principle

وَلَهُ مِنَ الْعُمُرِ ثَلاثٌ وَسِتُّونَ سَنَةً، مِنْهَا أَرْبَعُونَ قَبْلَ النُّبُوَّةِ.

He lived sixty-three years, forty of them before prophethood.

Third principle

نُبِّئَ بِاقْرَأْ، وَأُرْسِلَ بِالْمُدَّثِّرِ، وَبَلَدُهُ مَكَّةُ.

He was made a prophet with “Iqra’” and sent as a messenger with “al-Muddaththir”. His city was Makkah.

Third principle

Deep explanation

The last of the three principles is also a question in the grave: “Who is your Prophet?”. The author answers first with his lineage. This is not an exercise in memorisation. The lineage shows that Muḥammad ﷺ was from the noblest and best-known family of the Arabs, a descendant of Ibrāhīm, and that his honesty and reputation were known even before the revelation. Makkans called him *aṣ-Ṣādiq al-Amīn* (the truthful, the trustworthy).

Sixty-three years. Forty years of life before prophethood gave people time to know his character and made it harder to accuse him of lying. Then twenty-three years of revelation: thirteen in Makkah and ten in Madīnah. In that period he completed the message, built a community and changed the world. The student should reflect: how was so much achieved in so short a time? The answer lies in sincerity, patience, clarity of message and the help of Allah.

Prophet and Messenger. He was made a prophet with the first verses of Sūrat al-ʿAlaq: "Read in the name of your Lord who created." (96:1) The first command is to read, which shows the value of knowledge. He was sent as a messenger with al-Muddaththir 74:1–7: "O you who is wrapped, arise and warn." A prophet receives revelation; a messenger is also commanded to convey it to people. The first call was to read and learn; the second was to warn and call.

Makkah and Madīnah. Makkah was the place of the Kaʿbah and of the early persecution. Madīnah became the first Muslim community and the base of the state. The *hijrah* (emigration) was a turning point: not an escape, but a planned move to establish the religion. The Islamic calendar begins from it.

A final reflection for students: loving the Prophet ﷺ means obeying him, following his Sunnah, defending his honour with knowledge and sending blessings upon him. Love that is only words, with no obedience, is not what the Qur'an calls for: "Say: if you love Allah, then follow me, and Allah will love you." (Āl ʿImrān 3:31)

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Nabī	A prophet: one who receives revelation
Rasūl	A messenger: sent with a message and commanded to convey it
Hijrah	Emigration from Makkah to Madīnah
Aṣ-Ṣādiq al-Amīn	The truthful, the trustworthy: the Prophet's title before prophethood

Chapter summary

- His name and lineage: Muḥammad ibn ʿAbdillāh, of Quraysh, a descendant of Ismāʿīl and Ibrāhīm.
- He lived 63 years: 40 before prophethood, 23 as a prophet and messenger.
- Prophet through Iqra'; messenger through al-Muddaththir.
- Born in Makkah; emigrated to Madīnah.

Short essay

Question: In about 200 words, explain why the forty years before prophethood matter for believing his message.

Write your answer on a separate page. Compare it with the guide points at the back of the book.

Practical task

Draw a timeline of the Prophet's life: birth, age 40 (first revelation), 13 years in Makkah, hijrah, 10 years in Madīnah, death at 63. Beside each mark, write one lesson. Then write one sunnah you will practise this week.

Quick quiz

Choose the best answer. Answers are at the back of the book.

1. **How old was the Prophet ﷺ when he died?**
   a) 40 b) 23 c) 70 d) 63

2. **The first revelation began with:**
   a) al-Muddaththir b) Iqra' c) al-Fātiḥah d) al-Ikhlāṣ

3. **How many years was he a prophet?**
   a) 40 b) 63 c) 23 d) 10

4. **To which city did he emigrate?**
   a) Jerusalem b) Madīnah c) Ṭā'if d) Jeddah

Chapter 8 Taghūt and the way of the messengers

What it means to reject falsehood and believe in Allah

The text

وَالطَّاغُوتُ عَامٌّ فِي كُلِّ مَا عُبِدَ مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ.

The ṭāghūt is general: everything that is worshipped besides Allah.

Closing section

وَرُؤُوسُهُمْ خَمْسَةٌ: إِبْلِيسُ لَعَنَهُ اللَّهُ، وَمَنْ عُبِدَ وَهُوَ رَاضٍ، وَمَنْ دَعَا النَّاسَ إِلَى عِبَادَةِ نَفْسِهِ، وَمَنِ ادَّعَى شَيْئًا مِنْ عِلْمِ الْغَيْبِ، وَمَنْ حَكَمَ بِغَيْرِ مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ.

The heads of the ṭawāghīt are five: Iblīs, may Allah curse him; whoever is worshipped while pleased with it; whoever calls people to worship himself; whoever claims some knowledge of the unseen; and whoever rules by other than what Allah revealed.

Closing section

وَلَقَدْ بَعَثْنَا فِي كُلِّ أُمَّةٍ رَسُولاً أَنِ اعْبُدُوا اللَّهَ وَاجْتَنِبُوا الطَّاغُوتَ

And We certainly sent into every nation a messenger saying: Worship Allah and avoid the ṭāghūt.

Sūrat an-Naḥl 16:36

Deep explanation

The author closes by explaining what “lā ilāha” (no god) rejects. The word **ṭāghūt** comes from *ṭughyān*, going beyond limits. In the broad sense it is anyone or anything that a servant exceeds his proper limit by worshipping, following or obeying in place of Allah.

He lists five heads of ṭāghūt. **Iblīs** calls to disobedience. **Whoever is worshipped and pleased with it** makes himself a rival of Allah, unlike the prophets and righteous people who rejected worship being given to them. **Whoever calls people to worship himself** claims divinity or obedience that belongs to Allah. **Whoever claims knowledge of the unseen** (fortune-tellers, astrologers and the like) claims

a quality only Allah has. **Whoever rules by other than what Allah revealed**, while believing his rule is better or equal, replaces Allah's law with his own.

The student must be careful in applying this. The list explains *categories*; it is not a licence for accusing individuals. The proper reaction is to understand the category, protect our own faith from it and call others with wisdom. Allah says: "There is no compulsion in religion; truth has become clear from error. Whoever rejects the ṭāghūt and believes in Allah has grasped the firmest handhold." (al-Baqarah 2:256) Faith has two halves: rejection (kufr bi'ṭ-ṭāghūt) and belief (īmān billāh), exactly as in lā ilāha illā Allāh.

Every prophet came with the same message, as Sūrat an-Naḥl says: worship Allah and avoid the ṭāghūt. The languages, laws and times differed; the call to tawḥīd did not. That unity should reassure the student: the Qur'an is not a new invention; it completes the call of Nūḥ, Ibrāhīm, Mūsā and ʿĪsā.

In daily life, "avoiding the ṭāghūt" can be practical: refusing to follow any person, ideology or trend against what Allah has commanded; refusing to consult fortune-tellers and horoscopes; and refusing to obey any authority in disobedience to Allah. The ḥadīth reminds us: "There is no obedience to any creature in disobedience to the Creator."

Key terms

Term	Meaning
Ṭāghūt	Anything worshipped, followed or obeyed beyond its limit in place of Allah
Kufr bi'ṭ-ṭāghūt	Rejecting false objects of worship and obedience
Ghayb	The unseen: known only to Allah
Ḥukm	Judgement: ruling by what Allah revealed

Chapter summary

- Ṭāghūt is everything worshipped or obeyed in place of Allah.
- Five heads: Iblīs, one who is worshipped and pleased, one who calls people to himself, one who claims the unseen, one who rules by other than Allah's law.
- Faith has two halves: rejecting ṭāghūt and believing in Allah.
- Every messenger called to worship Allah and avoid ṭāghūt.

Short essay

Question: In about 200 words, explain what "rejecting ṭāghūt and believing in Allah" means for a young Muslim today. Give two examples.

Write your answer on a separate page. Compare it with the guide points at the back of the book.

Practical task

Write the five heads of ṭāghūt in your own words, with one modern example of the category for each (without naming individuals). Then write what a Muslim should do in each case.

Quick quiz

Choose the best answer. Answers are at the back of the book.

1. **What does ṭāghūt mean?**
   a) Only an idol of stone b) A type of prayer c) Anything worshipped or obeyed beyond its limit in place of Allah d) A place in Makkah

2. **How many heads of ṭāghūt does the author list?**
   a) Three b) Seven c) Ten d) Five

3. **Which verse says every nation had a messenger telling them to avoid ṭāghūt?**
   a) al-Fātiḥah 1:2 b) an-Naḥl 16:36 c) al-ʿAṣr 103:1 d) al-Ikhlāṣ 112:1

4. **Faith has which two halves?**
   a) Fasting and ḥajj b) Reading and writing c) Rejecting ṭāghūt and believing in Allah d) Giving and taking

Glossary Key terms

Term	Meaning
Aṣ-Ṣādiq al-Amīn	The truthful, the trustworthy: the Prophet's title before prophethood
Daʿwah	Inviting people to Allah with wisdom and good speech
Dhabḥ	Sacrifice offered to draw near to Allah
Duʿā'	Supplication: asking Allah and calling on Him
Ghayb	The unseen: known only to Allah
Hijrah	Emigration from Makkah to Madīnah
Ikhlāṣ	Sincerity: doing the deed purely for Allah
Islām	Submitting to Allah with tawḥīd, obeying Him and avoiding shirk
Istighāthah	Asking for rescue in distress
Iḥsān	Worshipping Allah as though you see Him
Khusr	Loss: the state of every person except those who combine the four matters
Kufr bi'ṭ-ṭāghūt	Rejecting false objects of worship and obedience
Murāqabah	Constant awareness that Allah is watching
Muwālāh	Taking someone as a close ally and supporter
Nabī	A prophet: one who receives revelation
Nadhr	A vow to do an act of worship for Allah
Qadar	The divine decree: knowledge, writing, will and creation
Rabb	Lord: Creator, Owner, Controller and Nurturer
Rasūl	A messenger: sent with a message and commanded to convey it
Rukn (pl. arkān)	A pillar: an essential part without which the whole is incomplete
Shahādah	The testimony of faith
Shirk	Giving to someone else what belongs to Allah alone
Tarbiyah	Nurturing something step by step until it is complete
Tawakkul	Trusting Allah while taking the means
Tawḥīd	Singling Allah out in lordship, worship and His names and attributes
Zakāh	Obligatory charity on wealth that reaches the minimum (niṣāb)
Āyah (pl. āyāt)	A sign: a verse of the Qur'an or a sign in the universe
Īmān	Belief in the heart, statement of the tongue and action of the limbs

ʿIbādah	Everything Allah loves and is pleased with, in speech and action, outward and inward
ʿIlm	Knowledge that is backed by proof and leads to action
ʿĀlamīn	The worlds: everything other than Allah
Ḥajj	Pilgrimage to the Sacred House, once for those who are able
Ḥanīf	One who turns away from falsehood and worships Allah alone, like Ibrāhīm
Ḥayāʾ	Modesty: a branch of faith
Ḥukm	Judgement: ruling by what Allah revealed
Ṣabr	Patience: staying firm in obedience, away from sin, and through trials
Ṭāghūt	Anything worshipped, followed or obeyed beyond its limit in place of Allah

Final test — Final practical test

Total: 50 marks. Allow 90 minutes. Sections A and B are written, section C is oral and section D is practical.

A. Short answers (20 marks, 2 each)

1. List the four matters every Muslim must learn.
2. Which sūrah did ash-Shāfiʿī say is enough as a proof?
3. Why did Allah create jinn and mankind?
4. Define tawḥīd and shirk.
5. Give three types of worship and one proof or reason for each.
6. What are the five pillars of Islam?
7. What are the six pillars of faith?
8. What is iḥsān?
9. State the lineage of the Prophet ﷺ up to Hāshim.
10. Name two of the five heads of ṭāghūt.

B. Short essays (15 marks, choose any 3, 5 each)

1. In about 150 words, explain why the author puts knowledge before action, and give one example from your own life.
2. In about 200 words, explain how a person can know Allah through His signs without seeing Him. Use at least two signs in your answer.
3. In about 200 words, explain the meaning of lā ilāha illā Allāh. Why is it more than saying “Allah is the Creator”?
4. In about 200 words, explain why the forty years before prophethood matter for believing his message.
5. In about 150 words, explain what it means that we were created “to worship Allah”, without limiting worship to prayer.

C. Oral (5 marks)

Recite, in Arabic, the passage on the four matters and Sūrat al-ʿAṣr to a teacher, then answer the three questions: Who is your Lord? What is your religion? Who is your Prophet?

D. Practical (10 marks)

1. Prepare a five-minute talk for a younger student on “Why must I learn before I act?” and deliver it to a family member or friend (4 marks).
2. Choose three types of worship and write how each shows itself in your day, in the heart, on the tongue and in the body (3 marks).

3 Keep a seven-day log of one private habit you improved this week with the awareness of iḥsān (3 marks).

Answers Answer guide

Quiz answers

Chapter 1: 1. d) Knowledge 2. d) Sūrat al-ʿAṣr 3. d) Those who believe, do righteous deeds, advise to truth and to patience 4. d) Knowledge before speech and action

Chapter 2: 1. c) To worship Him 2. a) Singling out Allah for worship 3. d) Shirk 4. a) Ibrāhīm

Chapter 3: 1. b) Creator, Owner, Controller and Nurturer 2. d) His signs and His creation 3. a) Fuṣṣilat 41:37 4. b) The Creator of these things

Chapter 4: 1. a) Supplication 2. c) Shirk 3. a) Permitted, it is within his ability 4. d) Together, balanced

Chapter 5: 1. a) Five 2. a) Nothing is worshipped in truth except Allah 3. a) Islam, īmān, iḥsān 4. c) Reciting a dua daily

Chapter 6: 1. a) Six 2. b) Removing harm from the road 3. c) Worship Allah as though you see Him 4. d) The divine decree

Chapter 7: 1. d) 63 2. b) Iqra' 3. c) 23 4. b) Madīnah

Chapter 8: 1. c) Anything worshipped or obeyed beyond its limit in place of Allah 2. d) Five 3. b) an-Naḥl 16:36 4. c) Rejecting ṭāghūt and believing in Allah

Essay marking guide

Chapter 1:

- Worship without knowledge can be wrong even when the intention is good
- Al-Bukhārī's chapter title and the verse he used
- An example: learning how to pray before you pray, or learning a ruling before a business deal
- Knowledge that is not acted upon becomes a proof against you

Chapter 2:

- Worship = all that Allah loves, inward and outward
- Examples: honesty, studying, kindness to parents, patience
- Sincerity makes an ordinary act an act of worship
- Shirk and tawḥīd as the greatest forbidden and greatest commanded

Chapter 3:

- Signs in the universe: night and day, sun and moon
- The idea that every creation points to a Creator
- Sun and moon are signs, not gods (Fuṣṣilat 41:37)
- Knowing the Lord leads to worshipping Him alone (al-Baqarah 2:21)

Chapter 4:

- What a person admits when they call on someone
- Hearing, ability and control as qualities only Allah has in full
- The difference between asking a living person for help and calling on the dead or the absent
- Allah's promise: "Call on Me, I will respond to you"

Chapter 5:

- The Makkans accepted Allah as Creator but still worshipped others
- Negation (no god) and affirmation (except Allah)
- The conditions: knowledge, certainty, acceptance, submission, truthfulness, sincerity, love
- How it affects daily choices

Chapter 6:

- Awareness that Allah sees in private
- Giving your best because of Allah, not for applause
- A concrete example for studying, prayer and phone use
- The two states: as though seeing Him; knowing that He sees you

Chapter 7:

- His reputation for honesty: aṣ-Ṣādiq al-Amīn
- His character was known to the people who first opposed him
- A person who never lied about people would not lie about Allah
- What this teaches us about building a good name before we speak

Chapter 8:

- Faith has a negation and an affirmation
- Examples: refusing to consult horoscopes; refusing to obey any authority in disobeying Allah
- Balance: no accusation of individuals; call with wisdom
- The same message was brought by all the messengers

Final test: short answers

- Four matters: knowledge, action, calling to it, patience.
- Sūrat al-ʿAṣr.
- To worship Him.
- Tawḥīd: singling out Allah for worship; shirk: calling on others besides Him.
- For example: supplication (the Prophet ﷺ said it is worship), fear, hope, trust, sacrifice, vows, seeking help.
- Shahādah, prayer, zakāh, fasting Ramaḍān, ḥajj.
- Allah, angels, books, messengers, the Last Day, the decree.
- Worshipping Allah as though you see Him; if you do not see Him, He sees you.
- Muḥammad ibn ʿAbdillāh ibn ʿAbd al-Muṭṭalib ibn Hāshim.
- Any two of: Iblīs; one worshipped and pleased with it; one who calls people to himself; one who claims the unseen; one who rules by other than Allah's law.

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وَمَا تَوْفِيقِي إِلَّا بِاللَّهِ

“And my success is only through Allah.” (Hūd 11:88)

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